

Figure 9: gtkpod in action

from the left-hand side pane, while on the right-hand side you find fields to fill/edit ID tags of the music file you select in the centre pane.

EasyTag provides an option to remove/add album art in the audio file. This is a great function for users who own portable media players with LCD screens. Users can watch and navigate through albums with the help of album art, under these circumstances.

Considering that hardware prices are continuously falling and that hard drive capacities are growing, users tend to increase their data collection. The same goes for media files. So, if you belong to that same race, it would be really hard for you to remember the ID tags for every media file. This is where Picard comes into action. Picard is an advanced ID tag editor that not only edits tags, but also uses the online MusicBrainz service to suggest ID tags for a particular track.

MusicBrainz has a voluminous collection of audio files, ranging from popular music to regional tracks. You can submit new music meta data at the website either through the software or using your Web browser.

After using Picard, I guess you are now ready with a completely 'dressed-up' music collection. However, we should add the final ingredient as well—the album art.

There are several ways to do this. The simplest is to leave it to your media player. Applications like Banshee and Amarok (Figure 8) automatically fetch album art and assign it to your album. They work magnificently with a lot of albums, but also fail when your album resembles the name of another international movie/album, in which case it may assign the wrong artwork.

To get the exact album art, you need to depend on Google/Wikipedia, or the website of the recording studio. Search online by album name for the album art/cover posted and save it to the respective album folders. Rename the file as 'Cover' or 'Album Art'. One thing to note about applications like Amarok and Banshee is that they automatically add the album art from the folder and will not fetch it from the Internet.

Owners of media players like Creative Zen, Cowon iAudio and others can easily add music by dragging and

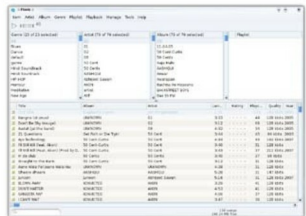


Figure 10: Floola iPod manager

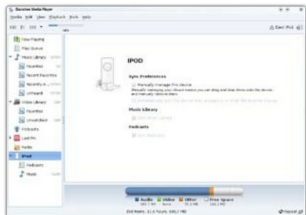


Figure 11: Banshee displaying iPod

dropping from Amarok or Banshee. iPod users can add media files from the suggested media player or they can use iPod managers. Linux has some great iPod managers like *gtkpod* (Figure 9) and *Floola* (Figure 10). All the iPod managers and media players will transfer album art along with media files.

That's it for now! Hope this article helps you to manage your music much more efficiently, allowing you to get the most of every new function that comes with the new breed of media players. **END** 

Resources

- Banshee Media Player: <http://banshee-project.org/>
- Amarok Media Player: <http://amarok.kde.org/>
- Easy Tag ID Editor: <http://easytag.sourceforge.net/>
- Picard Tagger: <http://musicbrainz.org/doc/PicardTagger>
- Banshee PPA: <https://edge.launchpad.net/~banshee-team/+archive>
- GTK POD: <http://www.gtkpod.org/about.html>
- Floola iPod Manager: <http://www.floola.com/>

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